

SAFE OPERATING PROCEDURE

Compressed air

LOCATION: Various

TOI-OHOMAI
Institute of Technology

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT



Version: 2	Key Contact: George Fisher
Effective Date: 18/09/2020	Speciality/Position: Technician
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Permits required	Confined space ☐ Hot Works ☐ Working at Heights ☐

HAZARDS ASSOCIATED WITH THIS EQUIPMENT

PERMANENT HAZARDS Remove as necessary	List	Control Method	Lock out Yes or No
Electric shock	Power cord	Test and tag, RCD if using outside or in damp conditions, check power cord condition.	No
Moving Parts	Unsecured air hose can whip around	Ensure the hose is secure before use. Cut air source if hose is out of control	No
Noise	Compressor noise	Wear hearing protection	No
Explosion	Rusty tank	Drain tank daily. Check for rust and replace as required.	No
Pressure	Pressurised air in contact with human skin is not good. Compressed air can enter blood vessels with life threatening consequences.	Direct air hose away from body when operating.	No
Moving materials	Air pressure can cause movement of particles from around the area of work	Direct hose away from body and wear PPE	No
Fire	Maintenance	Turn off at the mains and allow compressor to cool before changing oil or working on it.	No

PURPOSE/PROCESS

Clearing away debris, dust etc, any application where compressed air is required.

PROCEDURES:

DO NOT use this machine unless you have proven to your trainer that you are competent in its safe use and operation

Pre Start Check

1. Make sure that lines and fittings are secure (to walls and frames etc.) and there are no slip/trip hazards
2. Make sure there are no cracks or bends in all air hoses and that there are no leaks
3. Make sure hose clips and clamps are tight
4. Ensure the work area is well ventilated
5. Ensure you are familiar with the operation of the ON/OFF switch
6. Check that the regulator is set to the appropriate pressure for the activity

Operational Safety

1. Ensure all attachments used with the air compressor are in good condition before using
2. Be careful when attaching and disconnecting tools to the air hose. Hold the air hose and tool firmly during this process
3. Check the compressor regularly, noting pressure increase and cut-out/cut-in pressure
4. Listen for any leaks from any flexible airlines and immediately report any leaks
5. Adjust pressure regulator to suit work requirements

Close Down

1. Turn off and disconnect air tools
2. Leave the work area in a safe, clean and tidy state – remove any waste
3. Air hoses and electrical leads should be coiled with large loops

FORBIDDEN

- Never use compressed air to clean off clothes, workbenches or floor surfaces
- Never direct compressed air at your body or another person

	Name	Title/Position	Signature	Date
Author	Marie Dennis	HSW manager		
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Document Control

Date	Revision number	Modifications	Revised by	Approved by
3/12/2019	1	New template	Marie Dennis	George Fisher
10.03.20	2	updated	George Fisher	